



# ENERGY WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 5 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 11 SEPTEMBER 2026

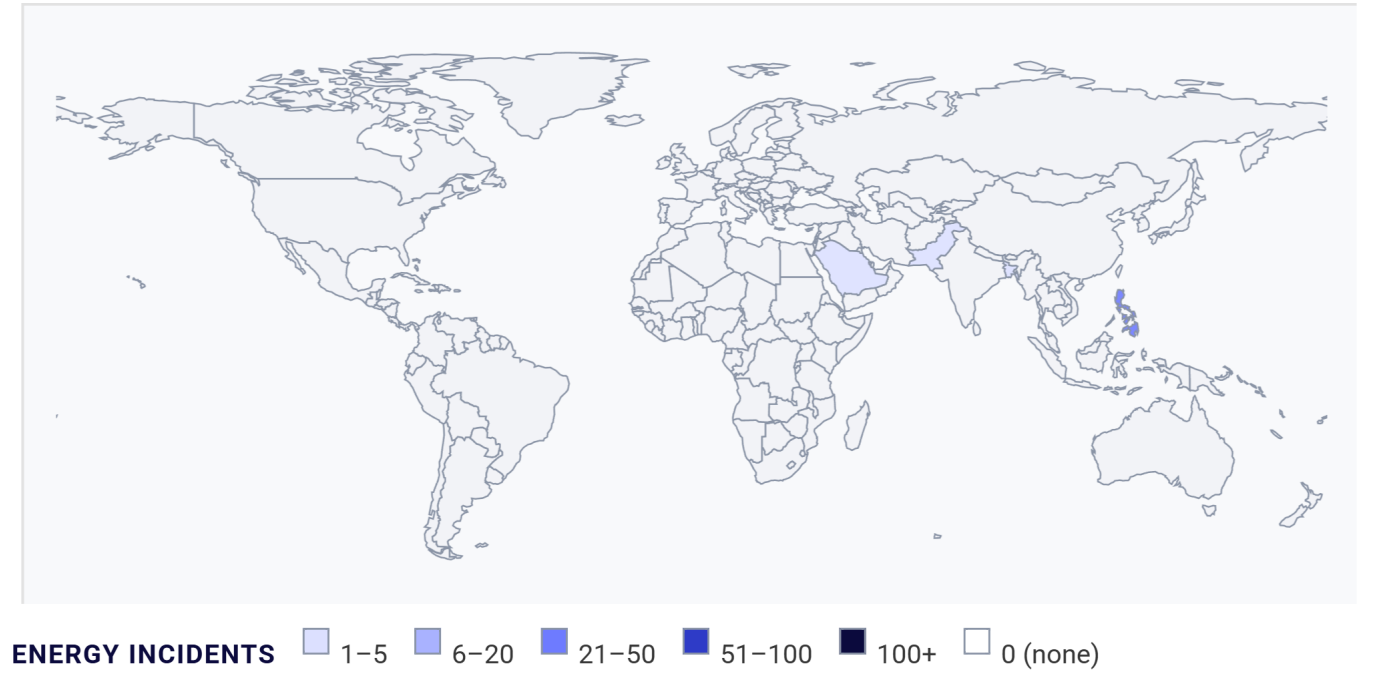
FAST FACTS

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>REPORTING PERIOD</div> <div>5 Sep - 11 Sep 2026</div>                                                                    | <div>MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY</div> <div>Philippines</div> <div>22 records</div>                                                      | <div>POWER SUPPLY</div> <div>Longer brownouts</div> <div>Cebu faces longer brownouts as Visayas power shortage worsens</div>          |
| <div>INFRASTRUCTURE OUTAGE</div> <div>Substation fire</div> <div>Substation fire cuts power to parts of Dhaka for hours</div> | <div>ELECTRICITY COSTS</div> <div>Higher electricity costs</div> <div>Brownouts now, higher Visayas power bills in September</div> | <div>BUSINESS IMPACT</div> <div>Market vendors affected</div> <div>Colon Night Market vendors grapple with rotational brownouts</div> |

BLUF

This window was defined by sustained power stress rather than isolated faults. The clearest pressure points were prolonged load shedding in Simkot, recurring brownouts and red-alert conditions in the Visayas grid, and a substation fire that cut power to parts of Dhaka for hours. Energy disruption risk is Moderate overall, with the most immediate continuity pressure where outages are already recurring or where a single infrastructure failure has shown the ability to interrupt supply quickly.

ENERGY SITUATION MAP



## MARKET PRICES

### ELECTRICITY (US CITY AVG)

US city average retail electricity

**0.197** USD/kWh

-0.5% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · BLS / FRED (APU000072610)

### NATURAL GAS (EUROPE)

EU import natural gas

**17.93** USD/MMBtu

+18.8% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · IMF / FRED (PNGASEUUSDM)

### NATURAL GAS (HENRY HUB)

Henry Hub natural gas spot

**2.810** USD/MMBtu

-2.4% 7d



As of 09 Sep 2026 · EIA / FRED (DHHNGSP)

### THERMAL COAL (AUSTRALIA)

Australian thermal coal

**140.4** USD/mt

-6.6% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · IMF / FRED (PCOALAUUSDM)

## ENERGY SITUATION

### PHILIPPINES / VISAYAS

The reporting period shows a mix of supply shortfall, grid instability and tariff pressure across several markets. In the Philippines, tight supply and power plant outages coincided with recurring rotational brownouts in the Visayas and a renewed red alert on the grid, while wholesale prices in the region rose sharply.

In South Asia, the pattern was more localised but still operationally relevant. Simkot was reported to be facing 22 hours of daily load shedding, and Dhaka saw both an hours-long outage after a substation fire and separate reporting that some load shedding would need to be accepted in the city. Pakistan was affected by electricity tariff pressure rather than a specific reported outage event in this window.

### BANGLADESH / DHAKA

The most acute single disruption in the window was in Dhaka, where a substation fire cut power to parts of the city for hours. Separate reporting from Dhaka indicated that some load shedding would need to be accepted, pointing to continued strain beyond the fire itself.

**PHILIPPINES / VISAYAS**

In the Philippines, the Visayas remained under pressure. Consumers were reported to have endured recurring rotational brownouts in August, with tight supply and power plant outages pushing wholesale electricity prices in the region to their highest level yet. The Visayas grid also slipped back into red alert, amid continuing and worsening outages, and the power shortage prompted a push to fast-track three energy projects.

Elsewhere, Simkot was reported to be facing 22 hours of daily load shedding. Reporting also pointed to load-shedding concerns in Bangladesh more broadly, while Pakistan saw attention on rising electricity tariffs and bills. Separately, vessels were reported hit near Hormuz as satellite images fuelled claims of an attack on a Saudi pipeline, a High-severity development for fuel-to-power risk because it raises pressure on energy flows even though no direct domestic power outage was reported in Saudi Arabia in this window.

**WHAT MATTERS**

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The operational significance lies in repeated or prolonged power interruption, not just one-off technical faults. In Dhaka, an hours-long outage after the substation fire would have disrupted lighting, cooling, communications and routine site activity in affected areas, with immediate effects on staff movement, building access systems and schedule reliability.

In the Visayas, recurring brownouts, red-alert conditions and tight supply create a more persistent continuity issue. The combination of intermittent interruption and higher wholesale prices points to pressure on both uptime and operating costs, especially where activity depends on stable power, cold storage or time-sensitive processing.

Simkot stands out for the severity of daily load shedding. At that duration, normal working hours, charging cycles, connectivity and basic services are all likely to be constrained, making backup power availability and fuel status the main practical focus.

**IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS**

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- Check backup generation readiness and fuel stocks at sites in Dhaka, the Visayas and Simkot.
- Update business continuity plans for multi-hour outages and repeated daily load shedding.
- Review shift timing and critical process scheduling where grid supply is already unstable.
- Confirm that access control, lifts, cooling and communications can operate during power loss.
- Prepare for higher electricity and generator running costs in the Visayas and Pakistan.
- Issue local staff updates in affected cities when outages alter travel timing or site access.

## WATCH NEXT

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- Further red-alert declarations or rotating brownout notices in the Visayas grid
- Additional reports of power plant outages or tight supply in the Visayas
- Any extension of load shedding measures in Dhaka beyond the current reporting
- Restoration updates and follow-on faults linked to the Dhaka substation fire
- Changes in daily outage duration in Simkot
- Further tariff or billing changes in Pakistan
- Confirmed impacts on Saudi energy infrastructure after the reports near Hormuz

## POLESTAR VIEW

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Risk level: Moderate. The most likely disruption remains repeated electricity interruption in the Visayas, Dhaka and Simkot, with the sharpest continuity pressure where outages are already prolonged or where grid conditions have returned to red alert. Prioritise backup power resilience, short-notice communications on access and timing, and cost controls where tariff and wholesale price pressure is rising.

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